Ford Motor Company

June 2001

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: Emission Recall 01E15: Certain 2001 Model Year Taurus and Sable Flex Fuel Vehicles Equipped with 3.0L Engines – Reprogram Powertrain Control Module

AFFECTED VEHICLES

Certain 2001 model year Taurus and Sable flex fuel vehicles equipped with 3.0L engines built at the Atlanta Assembly Plant and the Chicago Assembly Plant from May 3, 2001 through June 8, 2001.

REASON FOR RECALL

In the affected vehicles, the powertrain control module (PCM) was inadvertently programmed with software that causes the vehicle to operate using the gasoline default values regardless of the level of alcohol in the fuel.

SERVICE ACTION

Dealers must reprogram (reflash) the PCM using WDS or NGS.

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Vehicles with this software error lack a necessary element of emission control design, and vehicles with this error delivered to customers will need to be recalled. Sale of uncorrected vehicles to customers could lead to penalties under the Clean Air Act.

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information
Customer Letter

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information:……..……1-800-423-8851
Other (Dealer Only) Recall Questions:…… 1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,

Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

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EMISSIONS RECALL 01E15
Certain 2001 Model Year Taurus and Sable Flex Fuel Vehicles
Reprogram Powertrain Control Module

OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer Recall/ONP Involved Unit Listings available on QCDealer.com. Also, correct other eligible vehicles that are brought to your dealership.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Immediately contact any of your affected owners whose names are not on your VIN list but identified in OASIS. Give the owner a copy of the Owner Letter and schedule a service date.

REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- cannot be contacted.
- does not make a service date.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.

RENTAL CARS

Rental vehicles are not approved for this program.

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EMISSIONS RECALL 01E15
Certain 2001 Model Year Taurus and Sable Flex Fuel Vehicles
Reprogram Powertrain Control Module

LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	Labor Operation	Labor Time
Unable to reprogram Powertrain Control Module (PCM) – latest calibration already installed	01E15A	0.3 Hour
Reprogram the PCM	01E15B	0.4 Hour
Administrative Allowance	Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN"	0.1 Hour

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Part Number	Description	Quantity
FPS-8262	Authorized Modifications Label*	1

* Label orders come in packages of 25 and are provided at no charge.

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Ford Motor Company

A. R. O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs
48121
Ford Customer Service Division

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan

July 2001

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

Ford Motor Company values you as a customer and is committed to vehicle quality and the environment. Therefore, we are voluntarily recalling certain 2001 model year Taurus and Sable flex fuel vehicles equipped with 3.0L engines to update your vehicle's emissions control software.

What the emission concern is…

Your vehicle is intended for use with gasoline, alcohol, or gasoline/alcohol fuel mixtures. However, the powertrain control module (PCM) on your vehicle was inadvertently programmed with software that causes the vehicle to operate as if fueled with gasoline regardless of the level of alcohol in the fuel.

What Ford Motor Company and your dealer will do...

Ford Motor Company will reconfigure the PCM in your vehicle to correct this condition, free of charge. Owners who are affected by this recall are requested to return their vehicle to their dealer for this reprogram.

What we are asking you to do…

Call your dealer without delay. Ask for a service date for Emissions Recall 01E15.

When you bring your vehicle in, show the dealer this letter. If you misplace this letter, your dealer will still do the work, free of charge.

How long will this reprogram take?

The time needed to reprogram your vehicle is less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling issues, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time.

If you have changed address or sold the vehicle…

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us so we can update our records. If you have sold the vehicle, the information you provide on the postcard will be used to notify the new owner about this program.

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If you have concerns …

If you have trouble getting your vehicle repaired promptly and without charge, please contact your dealership's Service Manager for assistance. If you still have concerns, please contact the Ford Motor Company Customer Relationship Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you.

Call (866) 436-7332

Office Hours (Eastern Time Zone)
Monday – Friday: 8AM – 11PM
Saturday: 9AM – 6PM

Or you may contact us through the Internet …

Hearing impaired call (800) 232-2952
TDD for the hearing impaired.

www.ownerconnection.com

Quality Care service is there for you all year round.

QualityCare™ at your service

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we are here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company for automotive products and services. Again, we are sorry for the inconvenience. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,

Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

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48121
Ford Customer Service Division

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P. O. Box 1904
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For Owners in CA and MA only: Emissions Recall 01E15

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

Ford Motor Company values you as a customer and is committed to vehicle quality and the environment. Therefore, we are voluntarily recalling certain 2001 model year Taurus and Sable flex fuel vehicles equipped with 3.0L engines to update your vehicle's emissions control software. Your vehicle may be releasing air pollutants that exceed California emission standards.

What the emission concern is…

Your vehicle is intended for use with gasoline, alcohol, or gasoline/alcohol fuel mixtures. However, the powertrain control module (PCM) on your vehicle was inadvertently programmed with software that causes the vehicle to operate as if fueled with gasoline regardless of the level of alcohol in the fuel.

What Ford Motor Company and your dealer will do...

Ford Motor Company will reconfigure the PCM in your vehicle to correct this condition, free of charge. Owners who are affected by this recall are requested to return their vehicle to their dealer for this reprogram.

If you do not have this service done:

- Your emissions warranty may be reduced
- Your vehicle may not pass emissions or smog tests that are required in your area
- Your state Department of Motor Vehicles may not renew your vehicle's registration

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Vehicles registered in California or Massachusetts …

If your vehicle is registered in the State of California or the Commonwealth of Massachusetts, this recall must be completed prior to vehicle registration renewal.

After this recall has been completed by your dealer, you will receive a Vehicle Emission-Recall Proof of Correction certificate. Please make sure that you receive a certificate from your dealer and that you have it with you when you renew your vehicle registration.

It is also important for you to know that the certificate should be returned to the Department of Motor Vehicles (DVM) only if it is requested by the DMV. Otherwise, this certificate is to be held by you for your records.

If you have changed address or sold the vehicle…

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us so we can update our records. If you have sold the vehicle, the information you provide on the postcard will be used to notify the new owner about this program.

If you have concerns …

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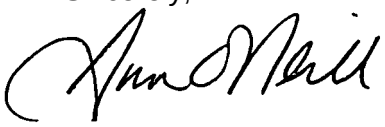
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Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we are here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

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